

Playwright Test — CLI Cheatsheet

Source: Naveen Automation Labs

#	Purpose	Command Syntax	Example
1	Run all tests	<code>npx playwright test</code>	<code>npx playwright test</code>
2	Run a specific test file	<code>npx playwright test <filename></code>	<code>npx playwright test tests/login.spec.ts</code>
3	Run a specific test using test name pattern	<code>npx playwright test -g "name"</code>	<code>npx playwright test -g "should login successfully"</code>
4	Run specific test using line number	<code>npx playwright test <filename>: <line></code>	<code>npx playwright test tests/login.spec.ts:15</code>
5	Run tests in a specific directory	<code>npx playwright test <dir>/</code>	<code>npx playwright test tests/api/</code>
6	Run tests with a specific tag (@tag)	<code>npx playwright test --grep "@tag"</code>	<code>npx playwright test --grep "@smoke"</code>
7	Run tests except those with a tag	<code>npx playwright test --grep-invert "@tag"</code>	<code>npx playwright test --grep-invert "@wip"</code>
8	Run tests in parallel (default)	<code>npx playwright test</code>	<code>npx playwright test</code>
9	Run tests sequentially	<code>npx playwright test --workers=1</code>	<code>npx playwright test --workers=1</code>
10	Run a specific test by name	<code>npx playwright test -g <test name></code>	<code>npx playwright test -g "Search box should be visible"</code>
11	Run using a specific config file	<code>npx playwright test --config= <file></code>	<code>npx playwright test --config=playwright.dev.config.ts</code>
12	Run using a specific project from config	<code>npx playwright test --project= <project></code>	<code>npx playwright test --project=chromium</code>
13	Run tests with a specific reporter	<code>npx playwright test --reporter= <reporter></code>	<code>npx playwright test --reporter=html</code>
14	Run tests in headed mode	<code>npx playwright test --headed</code>	<code>npx playwright test --headed</code>
15	Run tests in debug mode	<code>npx playwright test --debug</code>	<code>npx playwright test --debug</code>
16	Use environment variables	<code>ENV_VAR=value npx playwright test</code>	<code>BASE_URL=https://dev.site.com npx playwright test</code>

Quick Notes

- **-g (grep)** matches against the test title (supports regex).
- **--grep / --grep-invert** are used for tag-based filtering (e.g. @smoke, @wip, @regression).
- **--workers=1** forces sequential execution — useful for debugging flaky/order-dependent tests.
- **--project** refers to the named projects defined in playwright.config.ts (e.g. chromium, firefox, webkit).
- **--reporter** options include list, dot, line, html, json, junit.
- **--headed** opens an actual browser window instead of running headless — useful for visual debugging.
- **--debug** launches Playwright Inspector for step-through debugging.
- Environment variables can be prefixed inline (Linux/macOS) or set via `$env:VAR="value"` in PowerShell (Windows).

Common Combos

```
# Run smoke tests in Chromium, headed, with HTML report  
npx playwright test --grep "@smoke" --project=chromium --headed --  
reporter=html
```

```
# Debug a single failing test sequentially  
npx playwright test tests/login.spec.ts -g "should login  
successfully" --workers=1 --debug
```

```
# Run against a staging environment  
BASE_URL=https://staging.site.com npx playwright test --  
project=firefox
```